

Incomplete evidence and conflicting final records

Purpose

Provide a useful next investigation step when no specific runbook fits, source coverage is incomplete or authoritative records conflict. Unresolved is an honest outcome. Do not fill missing facts with alert text, a plausible narrative or the hidden scenario answer.

Payment Operations preserves the source inventory and question; Lifecycle Owner coordinates responsible source owners. Guidance can narrow the next evidence request without choosing a final cause or recovery action.

Document control	Value
Key / version	RB-111 / 1.0.0
Document ID	1e657081-25f3-41d1-a3e9-7b16b50a91e0
Owner	Payment Lifecycle Owner
Tenant ID	8b860d80-d17f-4e6b-8c48-af35f26a4d61
Status / effective	APPROVED / 2026-10-01
Approver	Knowledge Approver (fictional role)
Scope	cross-stage
Risks / sources	R20, R21, R22, R01, R17 / E01, E02, E03, E04, E05, E06, E07, E08, E09, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Construct an evidence and hypothesis ledger

Establish the question

Write the bounded claim being investigated: submission, explicit stage outcome, remaining amount, receipt or delivery. Assign its responsible source from E01-E11. An AVAILABLE aggregate error source cannot answer an individual payment question. Keep observation, hypothesis and missing source in separate fields.

For each attempted source, record tenant/operation scope, requested interval, snapshot identity, coverage, status, event/collection time and source version. Distinguish complete empty, partial, unavailable, timed out, malformed and stale. Do not replace an unavailable attempt with a later successful snapshot; retain both.

Discriminating requests

Unresolved question	Request and owner
Submission versus final result	E02 plus the stage acknowledgement; Lifecycle and stage owners
Lost response versus completed operation	Correlated E03/E04/E06 final record; responsible stage owner
Stale view versus contradictory final result	Source versions, coverage and projection lineage; stage and Platform Owners
Amount/cutoff disagreement	Linked operations plus E09/E10 complete comparison; Reconciliation Owner

List at least two plausible explanations when supported by the observed gaps, and state what evidence distinguishes them. This is not permission to invent unsupported causes. If two authoritative records disagree, retain both citations, check tenant/linkage and version semantics, and keep the conflict unresolved. Neither latest timestamp nor a vote across replicas selects the final outcome.

Escalate precisely and retain uncertainty

Request package

Name the source ID and owner, tenant/operation/window, distinguishing field, coverage required and possible interpretations. Ask for a source recovery checkpoint rather than an invented completion promise. Exclude foreign-tenant records immediately; a linkage mismatch is not evidence for this investigation.

Report boundary

Degraded or empty report evidence continues to require `INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`, `LOW` confidence and null cause/recommendation under Q6. This guide does not add an exception for helpful prose. Any report observation/inference must cite its own supporting record; knowledge is guidance, not occurrence proof.

Closure and audit

Close the investigation question with consistent bounded facts or an explicit unresolved state and owner evidence request. Preserve conflicting snapshots, failed attempts, hypothesis changes and human review. If later evidence resolves the question, retain the earlier uncertainty and create a new attributable attempt. No report decision contacts an owner automatically or executes remediation.

Only E01 is exposed by current MCP; E02-E11 are future requirements. If a source cannot be retrieved today, say so. Do not describe an unavailable console feature or claim that source recovery has happened merely because guidance suggests it.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: PL-101, PL-104, PL-105.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.